Measure M

Harmony Union School District

Measure Question

2/3 (Two-Thirds) Needed to Pass

To maintain and enhance quality education programs by funding Harmony Union School District's Garden Enrichment Program at Harmony and Salmon Creek School, a comprehensive farm-to-table interactive education program, as well as student mental health and academic intervention services, shall Harmony Union School District's education parcel tax measure be adopted, at the rate of $75 per year (raising approximately $177,600 annually), for four years, with an exemption for those 65 years and older and all funds spent on local students?

What Your Vote Means

YES	NO
A "yes" vote on Measure M is a vote to approve an educational parcel tax of $75 per year per parcel at a fixed rate for four years, commencing in fiscal year 2027-28.	A "no" vote on Measure M is a vote against the educational parcel tax of $75 per year per parcel at a fixed rate for four years.

For and Against Measure M

FOR	AGAINST
Susan F. Kirk School Neighbor Yuri Koslen Board Chair/President Harmony USD Susan McGovern Retired HUSD teacher of 30 years Colleen Lunardi Former Employee & Local Historian Jacqueline Gleason Harmony Ark Education Foundation	No argument was submitted against Measure M

Local Ballot Measure: M

Arguments and rebuttals are the opinions of the authors. They are printed exactly as submitted, including errors.

County Counsel's Impartial Analysis of Measure M

The Harmony Union School District ("District") has called an election to ask voters to approve a $75 educational parcel tax ("special tax"). If approved by two-thirds (2/3) of those voting, Measure M would permit the District to raise revenue to support the Garden Enrichment Program at Harmony and Salmon Creek School, a farm-to-table interactive education program supporting the District's food service program providing produce directly for student lunches; support student mental health services; and support academic intervention services for reading and math. Measure M was placed on the ballot by the Governing Board of the District.

Measure M would impose a special tax of $75 per year per parcel, raising approximately $177,600 annually to fund educational programs. This special tax would commence in fiscal year 2027-28 for a period of 4 years.

The proposed special tax would impose accountability requirements to ensure that funds are spent appropriately, including placing the funds in a separate, special account; restricting the use of the funds to those identified in the measure; and preparing an annual report showing the amount of funds collected and expended, and the status of any projects, programs or purposes identified in the measure. None of the funds could be used for administrator's salaries or pensions.

The special tax would be applied to each unit of real property in the District that receives a separate tax bill for property taxes. Multiple parcels that are contiguous and are part of one economic unit under the same name and ownership would be charged as one parcel. Exempted from this special tax are parcels which are exempt from property tax, or on which no property tax is otherwise levied, as determined by the Sonoma County Tax Collector. In addition, exemptions from payment of the special tax may be granted for parcels owned and occupied as a principal residence by persons 65 years of age or older as of July 1 of the tax year, parcels owned and occupied by persons receiving Supplemental Security Income for a disability regardless of age, and persons receiving Social Security Disability Insurance benefits, regardless of age, whose yearly income does not exceed 250% of the 2021 federal poverty guidelines issued by the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. Persons claiming exemptions based on senior, low-income or disability status would need to apply to the District for approval of an exemption.

A "yes" vote on Measure M is a vote to approve an educational parcel tax of $75 per year per parcel at a fixed rate for four years, commencing in fiscal year 2027-28.

A "no" vote on Measure M is a vote against the educational parcel tax of $75 per year per parcel at a fixed rate for four years.

JOSHUA A. MYERS
County Counsel

By: /s/ Ethan Pawson
Deputy County Counsel

Argument in Favor of Measure M

Harmony and Salmon Creek Schools are among the most important assets in our community and should be our number one priority. Quality schools improve student achievement, strengthen property values, prepare children for a productive future, and contribute to safer neighborhoods. Our teachers and staff do an outstanding job educating local children, but they need stable local funding to maintain the specialized programs and support services that help every student succeed.

State funding alone is not enough to protect the quality of education in the Harmony Union School District. Measure M would provide reliable local support so the District can continue offering the hands-on learning and targeted student supports that make our schools unique.

If passed, Measure M will provide dedicated funding exclusively for Harmony and Salmon Creek Schools, including: the Garden Enrichment Program, a comprehensive farm-to-table interactive education program integrated with the District's food service program that provides fresh produce from the garden directly to student lunches; student mental health services; and academic intervention services for reading and math. These funds may not be used for any other purpose.

Measure M makes financial sense and protects taxpayers. By law, all spending must be reviewed and annually audited by an independent citizens' oversight committee. Every dollar must stay local and can only be used for the specific programs listed above—not for administrator salaries. Funds cannot be taken by the State.

Measure M invests in the education and well-being of local children, supports our farm-to-table food service program, strengthens mental health, improves our reading and math programs, and helps maintain the quality of our community. That's something we can all support. Please join us and Vote Yes on Measure M!

/s/ Susan F. Kirk
School Neighbor

/s/ Yuri Koslen
Board Chair/President Harmony USD

/s/ Susan McGovern
Retired HUSD teacher of 30 years

/s/ Colleen Lunardi
Former Employee & Local Historian

/s/ Jacqueline Gleason
Harmony Ark Education Foundation

No Argument Was Submitted Against Measure M

Full Text of Measure M

HARMONY UNION SCHOOL DISTRICT
GARDEN ENRICHMENT PROGRAM FUNDING MEASURE OF 2026

This Measure may be known and referred to as the "Harmony Union School District Garden Enrichment Program Funding Measure of 2026" or as "Measure M".

TERMS AND PURPOSES

Terms. Upon approval of two-thirds of those voting on this measure (this "Measure"), the Harmony Union School District (the "District") shall be authorized to levy a qualified special tax (the "Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax") in the amount of $75 per year on each parcel of taxable real property in the District for no more than four (4) years, commencing July 1, 2027.

Purposes. The proceeds of this Measure shall be authorized to be used to fund (a) the Garden Enrichment Program at Harmony and Salmon Creek School, which is a comprehensive farm-to-table interactive education program integrated with the District's food service program, providing produce from the garden directly to student lunches, (b) student mental health services, and (c) academic intervention services for reading and math, and not for any other purpose.

Exemptions from Qualified Special Tax. In order to provide tax relief, any parcel owned and occupied by the following taxpayers shall be exempt from the Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax upon proper application to the District: (a) persons who are 65 years of age or older as of July 1 of the tax year; (b) persons receiving Supplemental Security Income for a disability, regardless of age; and (c) persons receiving Social Security Disability Insurance benefits, regardless of age, whose yearly income does not exceed 250 percent of the 2012 federal poverty guidelines issued by the United States Department of Health and Human Services. The exemptions shall be available pursuant to procedures to be prescribed by the Board of Trustees of the District (the "Board of Trustees") or otherwise as required by law or by the Tax Collector (the "Tax Collector") of the County of Sonoma (the "County").

Appropriations Limit. The District's annual appropriations limit shall be raised in each year the Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax is authorized to be levied in the amount of the funds raised by the Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax in such year.

ACCOUNTABILITY PROVISIONS

Separate Account; Annual Report. Upon the levy and collection of the Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax, the Board of Trustees shall cause an account to be established into which the proceeds shall be deposited. For so long as any proceeds remain unexpended, the Superintendent of the District shall cause a report to be filed with the Board of Trustees at least once a year, stating (a) the amount collected and expended in such year, and (b) the status of any projects or description of any programs required or authorized to be funded under this Measure. The report may relate to the calendar year, fiscal year, or other appropriate annual period as the Superintendent of the District shall determine, and may be incorporated into or filed with the annual budget, audit, or other appropriate routine report to the Board of Trustees.

Use Limited to Specific Purposes. All of the purposes named in this Measure shall constitute the specific purposes of the Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax and proceeds of the tax shall not be applied for any other purposes.

LEVY AND COLLECTION

The Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax shall be collected by the Tax Collector at the same time and manner and shall be subject to the same penalties as *ad valorem* property taxes collected by the Tax Collector. Unpaid taxes shall bear interest at the same rate as the rate for unpaid *ad valorem* property taxes until paid. The collection of the Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax shall not decrease the funds available from other sources of the District in any period from the effective date hereof.

"Parcel of taxable real property" shall be defined as any unit of real property in the District which receives a separate tax bill for *ad valorem* property taxes from the Tax Collector's Office. All property which is otherwise exempt from or on which are levied no *ad valorem* property taxes in any year shall also be exempt from the Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax in such year. Any parcel owned and occupied by the following taxpayers shall be exempt from the Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax as provided in this Measure: (a) persons who are 65 years of age or older as of July 1 of the tax year; (b) persons receiving Supplemental Security Income for a disability, regardless of age; and (c) persons receiving Social Security Disability Insurance benefits, regardless of age, whose yearly income does not exceed 250 percent of the 2012 federal poverty guidelines issued by the United States Department of Health and Human Services.

The District shall annually provide a list of parcels which the District has approved for an exemption from the Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax to the County tax collection officials and otherwise comply with the provisions of Section 50079 of the California Government Code. The County Assessor's determination of exemption or relief of any parcel from taxation for any reason other than the exemptions provided for in this Measure shall be final and binding for the purposes of the Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Tax. Taxpayers wishing to challenge the County Assessor's determination must do so under the procedures for correcting a misclassification of property pursuant to Section 4876.5 of the California Revenue and Taxation Code or other applicable procedures. Taxpayers seeking a refund of Garden Enrichment Program Parcel Taxes paid shall follow the procedures applicable to property tax refunds pursuant to the California Revenue and Taxation Code.

SEVERABILITY

The Board of Trustees hereby declares, and the voters by approving this Measure concur, that every section and part of this Measure has independent value, and the Board of Trustees and the voters would have adopted each provision hereof regardless of every other provision hereof. Upon approval of this Measure by the voters, should any part be found by a court of competent jurisdiction to be invalid for any reason, all remaining parts hereof shall remain in full force and effect to the fullest extent allowed by law.